

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Nature of Politics and Communitarianism - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Nature of Politics and Communitarianism - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 07 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Politics**?

- A. A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.
- B. A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.
- C. Locke-linked liberalism treats society as composed of multiple organized groups seeking accommodation through the state.
- D. Politics as group-and-state activity aimed at reconciling competing interests and promoting a common good compatible with them.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Politics.
- **B:** B Attaches to Political situation, not Politics.
- **C:** C Attaches to Liberal-pluralist stream, not Politics.
- **D:** D Attaches to Liberal view of politics, not Politics.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Politics by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Political situation**?

- A. Locke-linked liberalism treats society as composed of multiple organized groups seeking accommodation through the state.
- B. A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.
- C. Politics as group-and-state activity aimed at reconciling competing interests and promoting a common good compatible with them.
- D. Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Liberal-pluralist stream, not Political situation.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Political situation.
- **C:** C Attaches to Liberal view of politics, not Political situation.
- **D:** D Attaches to Aristotle, not Political situation.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Political situation by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Authoritative allocation of values**?

- A. Politics as an effect of class division, used by the dominant class to hold down the dependent class until class society is abolished.
- B. A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community.
- C. Easton's idea that politics distributes valued things through decisions treated as binding because they carry authority, not mere brute force.
- D. Contemporary communitarians criticize the atomistic individual and stress embedded identity, virtue, shared understanding and common good.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Marxist view of politics, not Authoritative allocation of values.
- **B:** B Attaches to Communitarianism, not Authoritative allocation of values.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Authoritative allocation of values.
- **D:** D Attaches to MacIntyre, Taylor, Sandel, not Authoritative allocation of values.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Authoritative allocation of values by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Liberal view of politics**?

- A. Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.
- B. grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.
- C. Politics and the state arise from class division and serve dominant-class interests until class conflict ends in a classless order.
- D. Politics as group-and-state activity aimed at reconciling competing interests and promoting a common good compatible with them.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Aristotle, not Liberal view of politics.
- **B:** B Attaches to Charles Taylor - significance, not Liberal view of politics.
- **C:** C Attaches to Marx and Engels, not Liberal view of politics.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Liberal view of politics.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Liberal view of politics by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Marxist view of politics**?

- A. Politics as an effect of class division, used by the dominant class to hold down the dependent class until class society is abolished.
- B. grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.
- C. Politics and the state arise from class division and serve dominant-class interests until class conflict ends in a classless order.
- D. Contemporary communitarians criticize the atomistic individual and stress embedded identity, virtue, shared understanding and common good.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Marxist view of politics.
- **B:** B Attaches to Charles Taylor - significance, not Marxist view of politics.
- **C:** C Attaches to Marx and Engels, not Marxist view of politics.
- **D:** D Attaches to MacIntyre, Taylor, Sandel, not Marxist view of politics.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Marxist view of politics by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Communitarianism**?

- A. Contemporary communitarians criticize the atomistic individual and stress embedded identity, virtue, shared understanding and common good.
- B. A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community.
- C. Easton's idea that politics distributes valued things through decisions treated as binding because they carry authority, not mere brute force.
- D. Politics as an effect of class division, used by the dominant class to hold down the dependent class until class society is abolished.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to MacIntyre, Taylor, Sandel, not Communitarianism.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Communitarianism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Authoritative allocation of values, not Communitarianism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Marxist view of politics, not Communitarianism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Communitarianism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Aristotle**?

- A. Politics as group-and-state activity aimed at reconciling competing interests and promoting a common good compatible with them.
- B. Politics and the state arise from class division and serve dominant-class interests until class conflict ends in a classless order.
- C. Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.
- D. grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Liberal view of politics, not Aristotle.
- **B:** B Attaches to Marx and Engels, not Aristotle.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Aristotle.
- **D:** D Attaches to Charles Taylor - significance, not Aristotle.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Aristotle by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **David Easton**?

- A. Reconciliation and authoritative settlement of disputes.
- B. A plurality of individuals and groups with reconcilable interests.
- C. A balanced outcome accommodating contending interests.
- D. Politics is the authoritative allocation of values for society.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Nature of politics, not David Easton.
- **B:** B Attaches to Image of society, not David Easton.
- **C:** C Attaches to Common good, not David Easton.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for David Easton.

Examiner trap: Do not identify David Easton by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Liberal-pluralist stream - Locke-linked liberalism treats society as composed of multiple organized groups seeking accommodation through the state.
- B. Political situation - Politics and the state arise from class division and serve dominant-class interests until class conflict ends in a classless order.
- C. Liberal view of politics - grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.
- D. Aristotle - Politics as an effect of class division, used by the dominant class to hold down the dependent class until class society is abolished.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source-exact: Liberal-pluralist stream is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Political situation is recorded with A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Liberal view of politics is recorded with Politics as group-and-state activity aimed at reconciling competing interests and promoting a common good compatible with them.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Aristotle is recorded with Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Liberal-pluralist stream; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Aristotle - Easton's idea that politics distributes valued things through decisions treated as binding because they carry authority, not mere brute force.
- B. Marx and Engels - Politics and the state arise from class division and serve dominant-class interests until class conflict ends in a classless order.
- C. Marxist view of politics - Contemporary communitarians criticize the atomistic individual and stress embedded identity, virtue, shared understanding and common good.
- D. Charles Taylor - significance - Politics as group-and-state activity aimed at reconciling competing interests and promoting a common good compatible with them.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Aristotle is recorded with Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.
- **B:** B Kept where the source puts it: Marx and Engels is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Marxist view of politics is recorded with Politics as an effect of class division, used by the dominant class to hold down the dependent class until class society is abolished.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Charles Taylor - significance is recorded with grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Marx and Engels; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Authoritative allocation of values - Politics and the state arise from class division and serve dominant-class interests until class conflict ends in a classless order.
- B. Marxist view of politics - A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community.
- C. MacIntyre, Taylor, Sandel - Contemporary communitarians criticize the atomistic individual and stress embedded identity, virtue, shared understanding and common good. (PDF pp.101, 105)
- D. Charles Taylor - significance - Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Authoritative allocation of values is recorded with Easton's idea that politics distributes valued things through decisions treated as binding because they carry authority, not mere brute force.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Marxist view of politics is recorded with Politics as an effect of class division, used by the dominant class to hold down the dependent class until class society is abolished.
- **C:** C Matches the record: MacIntyre, Taylor, Sandel is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Charles Taylor - significance is recorded with grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to MacIntyre, Taylor, Sandel; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Nature of politics - A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society. (PDF pp.95-99)
- B. David Easton - Order, justice and welfare within society.
- C. Common good - A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement. (PDF p.96)
- D. Image of society - A plurality of individuals and groups with reconcilable interests.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Nature of politics is recorded with Reconciliation and authoritative settlement of disputes.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: David Easton is recorded with Politics is the authoritative allocation of values for society.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Common good is recorded with A balanced outcome accommodating contending interests.
- **D:** D Exact pair: Image of society is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Image of society; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Nature of politics - Reconciliation and authoritative settlement of disputes.
- B. Common good - Order, justice and welfare within society.
- C. David Easton - A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society. (PDF pp.95-99)
- D. Image of society - A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement. (PDF p.96)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source-exact: Nature of politics is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Common good is recorded with A balanced outcome accommodating contending interests.
- **C:** C Not this pair: David Easton is recorded with Politics is the authoritative allocation of values for society.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Image of society is recorded with A plurality of individuals and groups with reconcilable interests.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Nature of politics; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Nature of politics - Order, justice and welfare within society.
- B. Common good - A balanced outcome accommodating contending interests.
- C. David Easton - A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society. (PDF pp.95-99)
- D. Image of society - A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement. (PDF p.96)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Nature of politics is recorded with Reconciliation and authoritative settlement of disputes.
- **B:** B Correct attachment: Common good is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: David Easton is recorded with Politics is the authoritative allocation of values for society.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Image of society is recorded with A plurality of individuals and groups with reconcilable interests.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Common good; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Nature of politics - A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society. (PDF pp.95-99)
- B. Common good - A plurality of individuals and groups with reconcilable interests.
- C. End-point - Order, justice and welfare within society.
- D. David Easton - A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement. (PDF p.96)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Nature of politics is recorded with Reconciliation and authoritative settlement of disputes.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Common good is recorded with A balanced outcome accommodating contending interests.
- **C:** C Records the association: End-point is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: David Easton is recorded with Politics is the authoritative allocation of values for society.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to End-point; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Michael Sandel - mechanism - withholding or distorting recognition (of a person's or a group's identity/culture) inflicts real harm.
- B. Charles Taylor - dialogical self and recognition - morality cannot be reconstructed from an abstract, tradition-free standpoint.
- C. Michael Sandel - critique of the unencumbered self - if the self is constitutively social, justice cannot be derived from a purely neutral.
- D. Alasdair MacIntyre - tradition and practices - the self is unintelligible outside the narrative of a particular community and moral tradition; virtues are.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Michael Sandel - mechanism is recorded with real persons are partly constituted by their ends and attachments (family, community, tradition); a self that could stand wholly apart from all its ends to choose principles of justice is not a coherent picture of a person.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Charles Taylor - dialogical self and recognition is recorded with the self is "dialogical," not monological - identity is formed through language and relationships with "significant others," and a person's self-understanding depends partly on being adequately recognised by others.

- **C:** C Misplaced: Michael Sandel - critique of the unencumbered self is recorded with targets Rawls's "original position," where parties choose principles of justice behind a "veil of ignorance," stripped of knowledge of their own particular ends and identity - Sandel calls this the "unencumbered self."
- **D:** D Records the association: Alasdair MacIntyre - tradition and practices is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Alasdair MacIntyre - tradition and practices; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Alasdair MacIntyre - mechanism** is associated with: a practice has "internal goods" (excellence achieved through the activity itself) understandable and judgeable only from within its own tradition of standards.
2. **Charles Taylor - mechanism** is associated with: if the self is constitutively social, justice cannot be derived from a purely neutral, ends-independent standpoint; political community itself has a claim prior to individual choice.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Alasdair MacIntyre - mechanism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Alasdair MacIntyre - significance** is associated with: grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.
2. **Charles Taylor - significance** is associated with: grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Alasdair MacIntyre - significance does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Charles Taylor - dialogical self and recognition** is associated with: the self is "dialogical," not monological - identity is formed through language and relationships with "significant others," and a person's self-understanding depends partly on being adequately recognised by others.
2. **Michael Sandel - critique of the unencumbered self** is associated with: targets Rawls's "original position," where parties choose principles of justice behind a "veil of ignorance," stripped of knowledge of their own particular ends and identity - Sandel calls this the "unencumbered self."

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Charles Taylor - dialogical self and recognition does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Charles Taylor - mechanism** is associated with: real persons are partly constituted by their ends and attachments (family, community, tradition); a self that could stand wholly apart from all its ends to choose principles of justice is not a coherent picture of a person.
2. **Michael Sandel - mechanism** is associated with: Easton's idea that politics distributes valued things through decisions treated as binding because they carry authority, not mere brute force.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Charles Taylor - mechanism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Charles Taylor - significance** is associated with: grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition - a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.
2. **Michael Sandel - significance** is associated with: Politics as group-and-state activity aimed at reconciling competing interests and promoting a common good compatible with them.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Charles Taylor - significance does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Michael Sandel - critique of the unencumbered self** is associated with: A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.
2. **Politics** is associated with: A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Michael Sandel - critique of the unencumbered self does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Michael Sandel - mechanism** is associated with: real persons are partly constituted by their ends and attachments (family, community, tradition); a self that could stand wholly apart from all its ends to choose principles of justice is not a coherent picture of a person.
2. **Political situation** is associated with: A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Michael Sandel - mechanism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Michael Sandel - significance** is associated with: Easton's idea that politics distributes valued things through decisions treated as binding because they carry authority, not mere brute force.
2. **Authoritative allocation of values** is associated with: Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Michael Sandel - significance does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Politics means only party competition or elections.?**

- A. Gauba widens politics to public conflict-resolution and authoritative value-allocation. (PDF pp.95-99)
- B. Only public conflicts requiring a universal/public solution count as properly political. (PDF p.96)
- C. Marxist analysis treats such compromise as often imposed within relations of domination. (PDF pp.103-106)
- D. Politics means A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba widens politics to public conflict-resolution and authoritative value-allocation. (PDF pp.95-99).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Any quarrel becomes political.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Marxism treats every visible compromise as genuine reconciliation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Politics means A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Politics means only party competition or elections, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Any quarrel becomes political.?**

- A. Gauba widens politics to public conflict-resolution and authoritative value-allocation. (PDF pp.95-99)
- B. Only public conflicts requiring a universal/public solution count as properly political. (PDF p.96)
- C. Marxist analysis treats such compromise as often imposed within relations of domination. (PDF pp.103-106)
- D. Politics means A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Politics means only party competition or elections.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Only public conflicts requiring a universal/public solution count as properly political. (PDF p.96).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Marxism treats every visible compromise as genuine reconciliation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Politics means A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Any quarrel becomes political, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Communitarianism means total unanimity or denial of all real tensions.**?

- A. Gauba says it sees no *basic* conflict within community, but he does not present it as a magic erasure of actually existing inequalities. (PDF pp.106-107)
- B. Political situation means A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.
- C. Gauba presents it as a stress on common interest and cooperation, but he also says it becomes futile where wide disparities of power and opinion persist..
- D. In Gauba, liberalism does speak of a common good, but as something worked out through accommodation of interests. (PDF p.102); this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Communitarianism denies all conflict.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Political situation means Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba presents it as a stress on common interest and cooperation, but he also says it becomes futile where wide disparities of power and opinion persist. (PDF pp.106-107).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Liberalism ignores common good altogether.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Communitarianism means total unanimity or denial of, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Marxism treats every visible compromise as genuine reconciliation.**?

- A. Politics means A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.
- B. Gauba widens politics to public conflict-resolution and authoritative value-allocation. (PDF pp.95-99)
- C. Only public conflicts requiring a universal/public solution count as properly political. (PDF p.96)
- D. Marxist analysis treats such compromise as often imposed within relations of domination. (PDF pp.103-106)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Politics means A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Politics means only party competition or elections.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Any quarrel becomes political.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Marxist analysis treats such compromise as often imposed within relations of domination. (PDF pp.103-106).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Marxism treats every visible compromise as genuine, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Liberalism ignores common good altogether.**?

- A. In Gauba, liberalism does speak of a common good, but as something worked out through accommodation of interests. (PDF p.102)
- B. Politics means A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.
- C. Marxist analysis treats such compromise as often imposed within relations of domination. (PDF pp.103-106)
- D. Political situation means A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: In Gauba, liberalism does speak of a common good, but as something worked out through accommodation of interests. (PDF p.102).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Politics means A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Marxism treats every visible compromise as genuine reconciliation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Political situation means Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Liberalism ignores common good altogether, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Communitarianism denies all conflict.**?

- A. Political situation means A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.
- B. Gauba says it sees no *basic* conflict within community, but he does not present it as a magic erasure of actually existing inequalities. (PDF pp.106-107)
- C. Gauba presents it as a stress on common interest and cooperation, but he also says it becomes futile where wide disparities of power and opinion persist..
- D. In Gauba, liberalism does speak of a common good, but as something worked out through accommodation of interests. (PDF p.102)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Political situation means Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba says it sees no *basic* conflict within community, but he does not present it as a magic erasure of actually existing inequalities. (PDF pp.106-107).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Communitarianism means total unanimity or denial of all real tensions.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Liberalism ignores common good altogether.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Communitarianism denies all conflict, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Politics means A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community.?**

- A. Gauba widens politics to public conflict-resolution and authoritative value-allocation. (PDF pp.95-99)
- B. Marxist analysis treats such compromise as often imposed within relations of domination. (PDF pp.103-106)
- C. Politics means A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.
- D. In Gauba, liberalism does speak of a common good, but as something worked out through accommodation of interests. (PDF p.102)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Politics means only party competition or elections.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Marxism treats every visible compromise as genuine reconciliation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Politics means A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value-allocation in society.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Liberalism ignores common good altogether.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Politics means A view stressing that persons are, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Political situation means Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his idea that political association is tied to good life.?**

- A. Gauba presents it as a stress on common interest and cooperation, but he also says it becomes futile where wide disparities of power and opinion persist..
- B. Gauba says it sees no *basic* conflict within community, but he does not present it as a magic erasure of actually existing inequalities. (PDF pp.106-107)
- C. In Gauba, liberalism does speak of a common good, but as something worked out through accommodation of interests. (PDF p.102)
- D. Political situation means A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Communitarianism means total unanimity or denial of all real tensions.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Communitarianism denies all conflict.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Liberalism ignores common good altogether.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Political situation means A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a universal/public solution, not a private settlement.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Political situation means Politics begins with the, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Nature of Politics and Communitarianism** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Define a political situation and explain why authority, rather than brute force, is central to Easton's account of politics. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *discuss* requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of a political situation and explain why authority, rather than brute force, is central to Easton's account of politics in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, David Easton's and Scarce, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Politics begins where public conflict requires a binding settlement, but it remains political only when decisions claim authority rather than reducing collective order to naked violence.

Model answer (148 words):

Introduction: A political situation arises when conflict over a public issue affects significant groups and requires a solution binding on society rather than a private settlement. Core analysis: David Easton's formulation of politics as the authoritative allocation of values identifies both the object and the mode of political decision. Scarce or valued goods, burdens and opportunities are distributed through public policy. The resulting decisions are political because they are treated as binding by the community and are backed by recognised institutions. Authority may draw on legitimacy, habit, consent and the possibility of sanctions, whereas brute force secures only immediate submission. The analytical point is that durable political order claims a publicly binding right to decide; violence alone cannot supply that claim. Conclusion: Politics begins where public conflict requires a binding settlement, but it remains political only when decisions claim authority rather than reducing collective order to naked violence.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *discuss* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, David Easton's and Scarce), converts that evidence into analysis of a political situation and explain why authority, rather than brute force, is central to Easton's account of politics, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Politics begins where public conflict requires a binding settlement, but it remains political only when decisions claim authority rather than reducing collective order to naked violence. At 148 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish the liberal, Marxist and communitarian views of politics. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *distinguish* requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of the liberal, Marxist and communitarian views of politics in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Liberal, Marxist and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that core analysis: The liberal view sees individuals and organised groups with diverse but reconcilable interests.

Model answer (142 words):

Introduction: Liberal, Marxist and communitarian theories define politics differently because each begins from a different image of society. Core analysis: The liberal view sees individuals and organised groups with diverse but

reconcilable interests. Politics uses legitimate rules, bargaining and authoritative decisions to produce order, justice and welfare; its organising ideal is liberty. Marxism begins from antagonistic classes structured by ownership and exploitation. Political compromise inside class society often manages or suppresses conflict while preserving dominant-class power; its organising ideal is equality and its horizon is a classless society. Gauba's conditional conclusion is crucial: reconciliation is less plausible under extreme domination, while communitarian cooperation is less plausible amid deep inequality and disagreement. Conclusion: The three views are rival social ontologies, not merely rival policies: liberalism begins from plural interests, Marxism from antagonistic classes, and communitarianism from socially embedded persons pursuing a shared good.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Liberal, Marxist and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of the liberal, Marxist and communitarian views of politics, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that core analysis: The liberal view sees individuals and organised groups with diverse but reconcilable interests. At 142 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Examine the communitarian critique of the atomistic liberal self with reference to MacIntyre, Taylor and Sandel. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive examine requires the answer to test the proposition rather than describe it, weighing what supports and what weakens it. Fix the boundary of the communitarian critique of the atomistic liberal self with reference to MacIntyre, Taylor and Sandel in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Communitarianism, Core and MacIntyre, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The communitarian critique successfully exposes the social conditions of agency, but it does not eliminate liberal rights;.

Model answer (145 words):

Introduction: Communitarianism challenges the liberal picture of a self whose identity and purposes can be understood independently of social membership. Core analysis: MacIntyre argues that persons acquire virtues through practices, narratives and inherited traditions. The standards internal to medicine, craft or scholarship cannot be generated by an isolated chooser. Taylor describes identity as dialogical: language and relations with significant others make self-understanding possible, while misrecognition can damage persons and groups. Sandel targets Rawls's supposedly unencumbered chooser. Actual persons are partly constituted by attachments and ends, so justice cannot simply begin from a self pictured as prior to them. Communitarianism therefore establishes social embeddedness, but not the moral authority of every existing community. Conclusion: The communitarian critique successfully exposes the social conditions of agency, but it does not eliminate liberal rights; it requires a more socially situated liberalism capable of protecting both belonging and critical independence.

Why this earns marks: it obeys examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Communitarianism, Core and MacIntyre), converts that evidence into analysis of the communitarian critique of the atomistic liberal self with reference to MacIntyre, Taylor and Sandel, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The communitarian critique successfully exposes the social conditions of agency, but it does not eliminate liberal rights;. At 145 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Is liberal neutrality possible? Discuss the communitarian objection and the liberal reply. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive is requires the answer to take a side, defend it and concede the strongest point against it. Fix the boundary of liberal neutrality possible? Discuss the communitarian objection and the liberal reply in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Liberal, Core and Communitarians, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that neutrality is therefore plausible as restraint against comprehensive coercion, but implausible as complete value-freedom.

Model answer (200 words):

Introduction: Liberal neutrality means that political institutions should not impose one comprehensive conception of the good on citizens who reasonably disagree. Core analysis: Communitarians object that neutrality is neither possible nor

innocent. A liberal state already values autonomy, rights and the choosing individual, so it promotes a particular moral image while claiming to stand above competing goods. It may also weaken the practices and loyalties on which citizenship depends. The Rawlsian reply distinguishes political from metaphysical neutrality. Fair procedures and equal liberties do not assert that persons lack constitutive attachments; they specify terms of cooperation acceptable across rival doctrines. Public institutions may support the capacities needed for citizenship without declaring one final way of life. Critical evaluation: The reply limits rather than abolishes the objection. Selection of rights, public reasons and institutional priorities always reflects judgments. Neutrality is therefore plausible as restraint against comprehensive coercion, but implausible as complete value-freedom. Its legitimacy depends on transparent justification and space for communal as well as individual forms of life. Conclusion: Liberal neutrality is defensible as a limited political rule of fair cooperation, not as a claim that the state or the self can be wholly detached from every conception of the good.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *is* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Liberal, Core and Communitarians), converts that evidence into analysis of liberal neutrality possible? Discuss the communitarian objection and the liberal reply, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that neutrality is therefore plausible as restraint against comprehensive coercion, but implausible as complete value-freedom. At 200 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Is politics best understood as reconciliation, class domination or pursuit of the common good? Critically discuss. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *is* requires the answer to take a side, defend it and concede the strongest point against it. Fix the boundary of politics best understood as reconciliation, class domination or pursuit of the common good? Critically discuss in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Politics, Marxist and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Politics cannot be reduced to one permanent essence: its dominant form depends on the depth of conflict, the distribution of power and the extent to which citizens can sustain a genuinely shared good.

Model answer (244 words):

Introduction: Politics is a public process of conflict, authoritative decision and collective order, but liberal, Marxist and communitarian theories disagree about its dominant social logic. Core analysis: Liberal pluralism interprets society as multiple groups whose interests can be accommodated through rules, negotiation and legitimate state action. Politics is consequently reconciliation directed toward order, justice and welfare. Marxism argues that this image understates structural power: where ownership divides society into antagonistic classes, compromise may suppress conflict while reproducing domination. Communitarianism rejects both the isolated interest-bearer and the permanently divided class model. Because persons are socially constituted, politics can express cooperation and a common good that comprehends members' flourishing. Gauba aligns the three views with liberty, equality and fraternity. Further development: The theories can also be treated as condition-sensitive diagnoses. Liberal reconciliation is most credible where disparities are moderate, institutions are legitimate and parties can bargain without dependence. Marxist domination becomes more illuminating where ownership structures bargaining power before public negotiation begins. Communitarian cooperation requires shared practices and sufficient social trust, but cannot be assumed in a fragmented or deeply unequal society. Liberalism is thin where bargaining positions are radically unequal; Marxism can reduce plural identities and institutional autonomy to class; communitarianism can romanticise solidarity where power and opinion remain deeply divided. Conclusion: Politics cannot be reduced to one permanent essence: its dominant form depends on the depth of conflict, the distribution of power and the extent to which citizens can sustain a genuinely shared good.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *is* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Politics, Marxist and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of politics best understood as reconciliation, class domination or pursuit of the common good? Critically discuss, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Politics cannot be reduced to one permanent essence: its dominant form depends on the depth of conflict, the distribution of power and the extent to which citizens can sustain a genuinely shared good. At 244 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate communitarianism as an alternative to liberalism, with reference to embedded selfhood, the common good and its limits. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of communitarianism as an alternative to liberalism, with reference to embedded selfhood, the common good and its limits in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Communitarianism, Core and MacIntyre, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Communitarianism corrects liberal atomism by restoring belonging, recognition and common purpose, but it remains defensible only when community is internally contestable and bounded by equal rights.

Model answer (244 words):

Introduction: Communitarianism is an alternative to atomistic liberalism because it treats social membership as constitutive of identity and political obligation rather than as a merely voluntary association among prior individuals. Core analysis: MacIntyre locates moral agency in practices and traditions; Taylor explains the dialogical formation of identity and the need for recognition; Sandel argues that the Rawlsian unencumbered self neglects constitutive attachments. These claims support a common-good politics in which duties, cooperation and fraternity matter alongside rights. Rousseau's general will and T.H. Green's social account of self-realisation may be used cautiously as precursors, not as contemporary communitarians. The approach illuminates local association, civic responsibility and the social foundations of individual flourishing. Further development: The Indian application should remain cautious. Constitutional life combines individual rights with directive duties and community-oriented purposes, illustrating an institutional attempt to hold liberty and fraternity together without treating either as absolute. The 27 July 2026 Panchayati Raj initiatives offer a current conceptual anchor: the Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme, SAMARTH Panchayat Portal and Model Own Source Revenue Rules seek to strengthen local collective capacity and revenue governance. They illustrate how common purposes may be organised through local institutions, but they do not prove that a village has one homogeneous good. Communitarianism therefore corrects liberal social ontology, but cannot replace constitutional protection of the individual. Conclusion: Communitarianism corrects liberal atomism by restoring belonging, recognition and common purpose, but it remains defensible only when community is internally contestable and bounded by equal rights.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Communitarianism, Core and MacIntyre), converts that evidence into analysis of communitarianism as an alternative to liberalism, with reference to embedded selfhood, the common good and its limits, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Communitarianism corrects liberal atomism by restoring belonging, recognition and common purpose, but it remains defensible only when community is internally contestable and bounded by equal rights. At 244 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
